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Brands We Know

Coca-Cola

By Sara Green



**Jump into the cockpit and
take flight with **Pilot** books.
Your journey will take you on
high-energy adventures as you
learn about all that is wild,
weird, fascinating, and fun!**

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What Is Coca-Cola?

More than 100 years ago, a Georgia drugstore **soda fountain** made history. There, Coca-Cola was poured into glasses for the first time. People found the sweet, refreshing soda to be delightful. Today, Coca-Cola is still popular. Coke, Diet Coke, Sprite, Fanta, and other favorite Coca-Cola drinks are enjoyed in almost every country on the planet.

The Coca-Cola Company is the world's largest **beverage** company. It owns more than 500 **brands**.

The company **headquarters** is in Atlanta, Georgia. Today, Coca-Cola is one of the most recognized brands in the world. It is also among the most valuable. In 2015, the company was worth nearly \$180 billion.



By the Numbers

more than
3,500
products sold
worldwide

more than
1.9 billion
beverage servings
sold each day

94%
percent of the world's
population recognizes
the Coca-Cola logo

more than
700,000
employees
worldwide

more than
**79 billion gallons
(299 billion liters)**
of water added to
Coke syrup each year

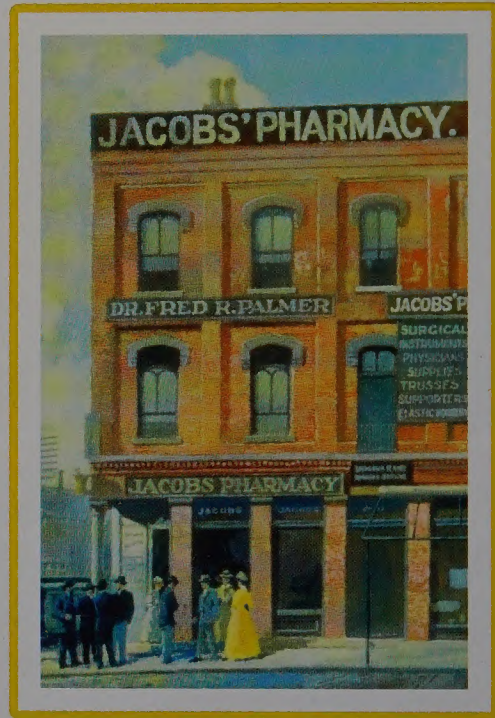


John Pemberton's Tonic

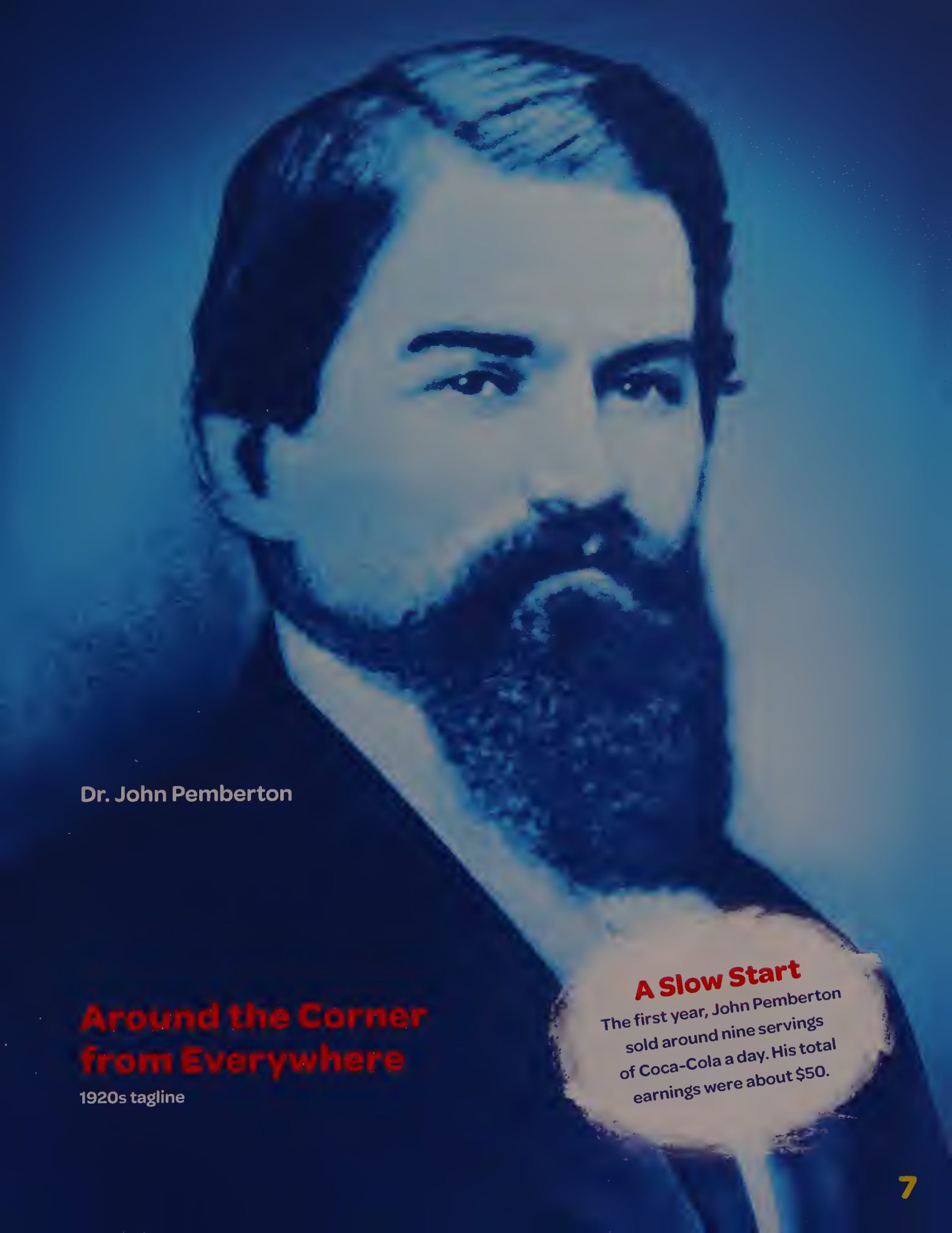
In 1886, Dr. John Pemberton invented Coca-Cola in Atlanta, Georgia. John was a **pharmacist**. He wanted to create a headache medicine.

Working in the back of his shop, John mixed many ingredients together. These included parts of the kola nut and coca leaf. John heated and stirred the ingredients. The result was a sticky brown syrup called a **tonic**.

John took the tonic to Jacobs' Pharmacy, a drugstore in Atlanta. There, it was mixed with **carbonated** water. The manager sold it at the soda fountain. Customers loved the fizzy drink! It sold for five cents a glass. John's business partner, Frank Robinson, suggested a name for the new drink. He combined the two special ingredient names into Coca-Cola. Then, he wrote the name in flowing handwriting. In time, Frank's writing became the company's **logo**.



Coca Cola

A black and white portrait of Dr. John Pemberton, a man with a full, dark beard and mustache, wearing a dark suit jacket and a white shirt with a dark tie. He is looking slightly to the right of the camera with a serious expression.

Dr. John Pemberton

**Around the Corner
from Everywhere**

1920s tagline

A Slow Start

The first year, John Pemberton sold around nine servings of Coca-Cola a day. His total earnings were about \$50.

The Coca-Cola Company

John was proud of Coca-Cola. But he decided to pursue other ideas. He began to sell his **shares** of the company. Many of them were sold to businessman Asa Candler. In 1888, Asa bought up the remaining Coca-Cola shares. In 1892, he formed The Coca-Cola Company. Asa wanted to make Coca-Cola even more popular. He gave out thousands of coupons for free drinks. He also **advertised** Coca-Cola on posters, calendars, clocks, and other items. Sales of Coca-Cola rose quickly. Asa opened new syrup plants in Texas, Illinois, and California. By 1895, Coca-Cola was being sold all across the United States.



Delicious and Refreshing

1900s-1920s tagline



Coca-Cola bottling
plant in North Carolina

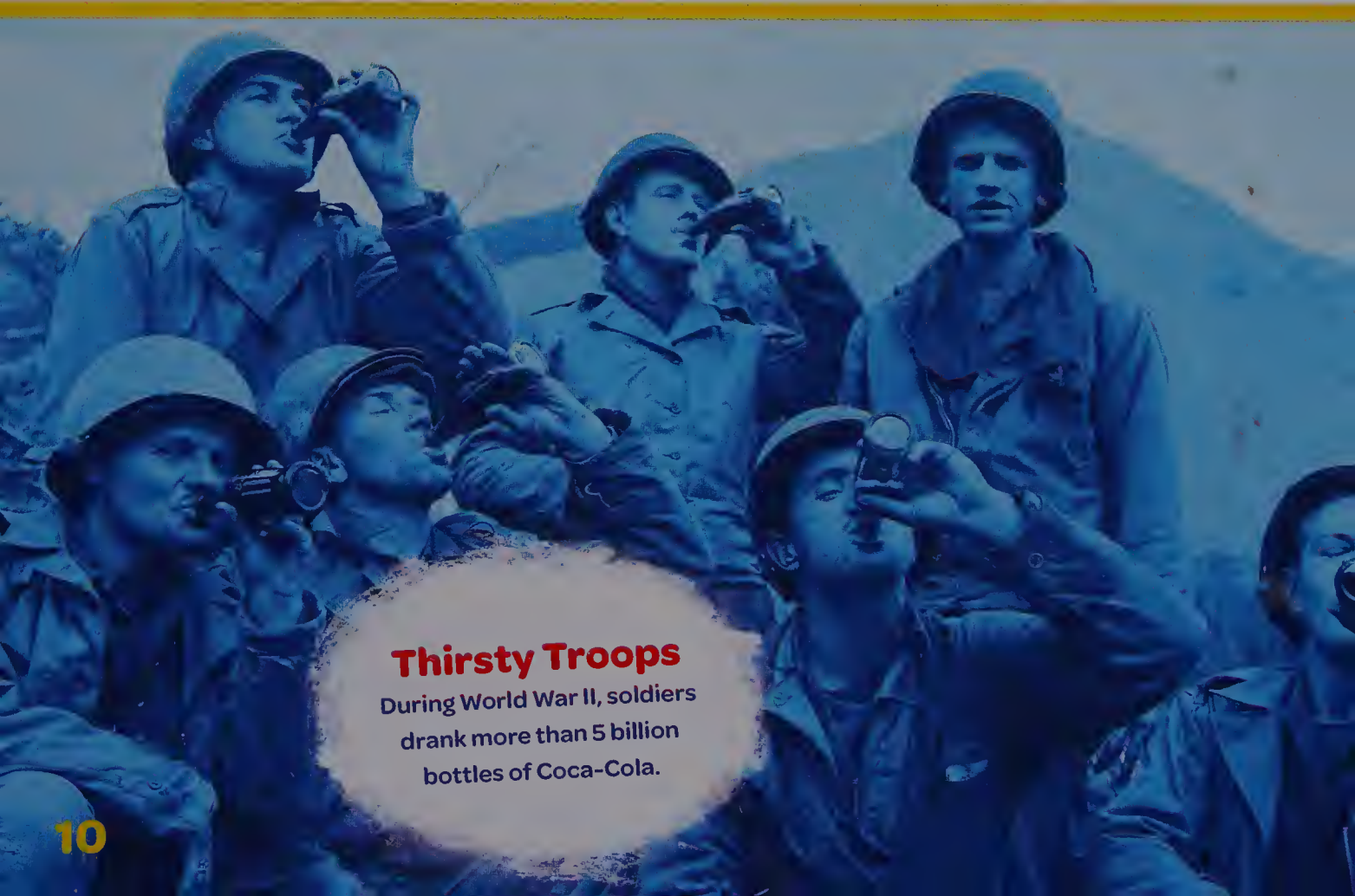
What A Bargain

Lawyers Benjamin Thomas and Joseph Whitehead of Tennessee bought the rights to bottle Coca-Cola for \$1. A third lawyer joined their business soon after.

People enjoyed drinking Coca-Cola at soda fountains. But many wanted to drink it at home. In 1899, with Asa's permission, three lawyers from Tennessee started to bottle Coca-Cola. The demand for bottles of Coke rose quickly. The three men could not keep up. They decided to sell bottling **rights** to others. By 1909, there were nearly 400 Coca-Cola bottling plants.

Sales of Coca-Cola continued to climb. Soon, Coca-Cola bottlers faced a problem. Other people were making similar products and bottles. Coca-Cola needed to stand out. In 1915, an Indiana glass company designed a new Coca-Cola bottle. It had the curvy shape of a cocoa pod. This bottle would become one of the most recognized packages on Earth.

By 1920, Coca-Cola was being bottled in more than 1,000 plants in the United States. The company also added new plants overseas during World War II to provide Coke to soldiers.



Thirsty Troops

During World War II, soldiers drank more than 5 billion bottles of Coca-Cola.

Coke Bottles

Through the Years



Coca-Cola ... Along the Highway to Anywhere

1940s tagline

The late twentieth century brought changes to the product line. Around 1960, people were able to buy Coca-Cola in cans. The 1960s also introduced products other than Coke. Fanta, Sprite, TaB, and Fresca appeared in the United States. People loved these new soft drinks! Mr. PiBB and Mello Yello were introduced in the 1970s. In 1982, Diet Coke came on the market. It soon became the top-selling diet soda in the world.

Serving Up Smiles

The Coca-Cola Company has achieved great success. But it has also experienced failure. In 1985, the company made a huge mistake. That year, it changed the original Coca-Cola recipe to make it sweeter. The result was known as New Coke. Many customers were unhappy and refused to buy New Coke. They wanted the original Coca-Cola back. In response, the company brought back the original **formula** as Coca-Cola Classic. It eventually stopped making New Coke. Coca-Cola fans were overjoyed. Sales of the soft drink became strong again. Today, Coca-Cola is the most popular soft drink in the world.



Jolly St. Nick

In 1931, Haddon Sundblom created an ad showing Santa Claus drinking a Coke. His illustration helped shape the modern image of Santa Claus.





Coca-Cola has gained customers through creative advertising. A 1993 commercial introduced cuddly polar bears as beloved **mascots**. Catchy Coca-Cola **jingles** have become radio hits. Much of Coca-Cola's advertising focuses on friendship, fun, and happiness. It features people enjoying good times together while they drink Coca-Cola. They find Coca-Cola delicious and refreshing!

Over time, people's concerns about **obesity** and other health risks have increased. Many people have cut back on sugary soft drinks. To keep profits high, The Coca-Cola Company bought other beverage brands. Today, the company owns Simply and Minute Maid, which are famous for their juices. It also owns Dasani bottled water and Powerade sports drinks. Odwalla, another Coca-Cola brand, is known for its juices and smoothies. One of its newest brands is called Fairlife. This company makes milk.



Simply



Minute Maid



Dasani



Powerade



Odwalla



Fairlife

A Coca-Cola Attraction

A vault in the World of Coca-Cola museum in Atlanta, Georgia, contains Coca-Cola's secret formula. Only a few top Coca-Cola leaders are ever allowed to see it.



.....
stevia

The Coca-Cola Company also added low-calorie soft drinks. Diet Coke and Coca-Cola Zero both have zero calories. However, Coca-Cola Zero was made to have the original Coke flavor. In 2013, The Coca-Cola Company introduced a soft drink called Coca-Cola Life. It is made with **stevia**, a natural sweetener. This means that the drink has less sugar. With so many choices available, Coca-Cola is sure to have a beverage for every person's taste!

A World of Flavors

Every day, nearly 2 billion servings of Coca-Cola beverages are enjoyed around the world. In most countries, people can find Coca-Cola, Diet Coke, Sprite, and other favorites. However, different cultures have unique taste preferences. For this reason, Coca-Cola does not sell the same beverages in every country. For example, in the United Kingdom, people enjoy a juice drink called Oasis. Flavors include black currant apple and mixed berry. A favorite drink in South Africa is Twist. Its flavors include lemon and mango. Tiky is a popular soft drink in Guatemala. It tastes like pineapple!



People can try new beverage flavors with Coca-Cola Freestyle. These soda machines are found in places such as restaurants and movie theaters. They offer more than 100 drink choices. People first select a beverage using the touch screen. Next, they choose a flavor, such as orange, raspberry, or vanilla. People love trying orange Coke, peach Sprite, and other delicious flavors!

Coca-Cola Brands Around the World

Brand Name	Country of Origin	What Is It?
Ambasa	Japan	Milk-flavored soft drink
Bistrone	Japan	Soup
Café Zu	Thailand	Canned coffee
Ciel	Mexico	Bottled water
Del Valle	Mexico	Juice
Dorna	Romania	Carbonated mineral water
Eight O'Clock	Philippines	Juice drink
Far Coast	Canada	Coffee and tea
Ice Dew	China	Bottled water
Lemon & Paeroa	New Zealand	Soft drink
Olimpija	Bosnia & Herzegovina	Mineral water
Powerplay	South Africa	Energy drink
Samurai	Vietnam	Energy drink
Ten Ren	Taiwan	Tea



Café Zu



Ciel



Far Coast



Powerplay



Samurai



Spreading Happiness

The Coca-Cola Company has a long history of **philanthropy**. Asa Candler and other Coca-Cola leaders were known for their generosity. Their donations have helped many universities, community groups, and hospitals.

In 1984, The Coca-Cola Company started The Coca-Cola **Foundation**. It has given more than \$650 million to projects all over the world. Many projects focus on protecting the environment. Some seek to improve education and health care. The foundation's projects often change people's lives forever. One has given many people in Africa access to safe drinking water. Other projects support community **conservation** and recycling programs. These include planting trees in Mexico and cleaning rivers in Tanzania.



Protecting Polar Bears

Polar bear homes are melting around the world. Coca-Cola is working with the World Wildlife Fund to help the bears. They plan to raise \$10 million to save their beloved mascots' home.



drinking water
in Africa

The Coca-Cola Company also supports a program called 5by20. Its goal is to help five million women succeed in business by the year 2020. The Coca-Cola Company continues to spread happiness through delicious beverages and projects that care for our world.

Coca-Cola Timeline

1886

Dr. John Pemberton
creates Coca-Cola

1892

Asa Candler
creates The
Coca-Cola
Company



1915

The contour
bottle is designed

1923

Coca-Cola begins using
the six-bottle carton

1928

Coca-Cola sponsors
the Olympic Games
in Amsterdam

1899

The rights to
bottle Coca-Cola
are sold

1919

Ernest Woodruff and a
group of investors buy
The Coca-Cola Company
from the Candler family
for \$25 million

1886

Frank Robinson names
the drink "Coca-Cola"
and creates the logo

1906

Coca-Cola bottling
operations begin in Cuba,
Panama, and Canada

1945

"Coke" becomes a
trademark of The
Coca-Cola Company

Coca-Cola

1950

Coca-Cola is the first product to appear on the cover of *Time* magazine



1965

Coca-Cola sponsors the first broadcast of *A Charlie Brown Christmas*



2009

Coca-Cola introduces Coca-Cola Freestyle

1960

Coca-Cola first comes in cans

1982

Diet Coke is introduced

2000

Coca-Cola is named the World's Most Valuable Brand

1961

Sprite is introduced



1971

The famous television commercial "I'd Like to Buy the World a Coke" airs

1993

Coca-Cola polar bears appear in the "Northern Lights" television commercial

2005

Coca-Cola Zero is introduced

1950

The first television commercial for Coca-Cola airs on Thanksgiving Day

Glossary

advertised—announced or promoted something to get people to buy it

beverage—something you can drink

brands—categories of products all made by the same company

carbonated—fizzy due to the addition of carbon dioxide

conservation—the protection of animals, plants, and natural resources

formula—recipe

foundation—an institution that provides funds to charitable organizations

headquarters—a company's main office

jingles—short, memorable songs used to promote things

logo—a symbol or design that identifies a brand or product

mascots—animals or objects used as symbols by a group or company

obesity—being extremely overweight

pharmacist—a person who prepares and gives out prescription medication

philanthropy—giving time and money to help others

rights—the legal ability to use a certain name or product

shares—units of ownership of a company

soda fountain—a shop or counter where drinks, ice cream, and occasionally light meals were sold

stevia—a shrub whose leaves are used to make a sweetener

tonic—a medicine used to increase energy and well-being

To Learn More

AT THE LIBRARY

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Griffin Llanas, Sheila. *Caleb Davis Bradham: Pepsi-Cola Inventor*. Edina, Minn.: Abdo Publishing, 2015.

Griffin Llanas, Sheila. *John Pemberton: Coca-Cola Developer*. Edina, Minn.: Abdo Publishing, 2015.

ON THE WEB

Learning more about Coca-Cola is as easy as 1, 2, 3.

1. Go to www.factsurfer.com.
2. Enter "Coca-Cola" into the search box.
3. Click the "Surf" button and you will see a list of related web sites.

With factsurfer.com, finding more information is just a click away.



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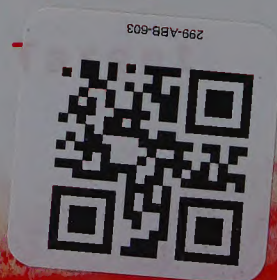
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